

Get the Best Out of MariaDB with Performance Tuning

MariaDB is one of the most popular database servers made by the original developers of MySQL, and has a strong developer and user community. Rugged as MariaDB is, getting the best out of it requires performance tuning. Read how to install MariaDB and tune it for better performance.



MySQL is one of the most popular open source databases in the world of technology. Earlier, MySQL was an independent company, which offered open source as well as commercial databases. Later, Sun Microsystems acquired MySQL, and then Oracle acquired Sun. When Oracle acquired Sun, the original MySQL developers forked a project called MariaDB, which was supported by a company called SkySQL. They took this step because they had fears about MySQL becoming closed source after its acquisition by Oracle.

After this whole saga, many Linux distributions started packaging MariaDB as the default MySQL server. Some distributions provide both MySQL (Oracle) and MariaDB, and leave the choice to the users.

Just like any other open source project, MariaDB is ahead of MySQL in many aspects; it has some enhanced features and usually goes through a faster release cycle – it brings out new features and bug fixes faster than MySQL.

MariaDB installation on Ubuntu 16.04 server

As of now, MariaDB maintains two versions, which are suitable for and usable in a production environment. These are 10.0 and 10.1. The 10.0 version is MySQL 5.5 with backported features from MySQL 5.6, whereas 10.1 is the current

supported release by the MariaDB team. It has a lot of new features such as Galera cluster and performance improvements. Ubuntu 16.04 repositories have the 10.0 version, which is fine if you are not interested in the new features. To install 10.1, you have to add MariaDB's repository to your aptitude *sources.list* file, which is available at the repositories page located at <https://downloads.mariadb.org/mariadb/repositories/>.

I am choosing the DigitalOcean mirror in my example below:

```
sudo apt-get install software-properties-common
sudo apt-key adv --recv-keys --keyserver hkp://keyserver.ubuntu.com:80 0xF1656F24C74CD1D8
sudo add-apt-repository 'deb [arch=amd64,i386,ppc64el]
http://lon1.mirrors.digitalocean.com/mariadb/repo/10.1/ubuntu
xenial main'
```

After adding the repository, fire this command to install the MariaDB server:

```
sudo apt update
sudo apt install mariadb-server
```

Aptitude will download and install the server for you, and